

Morphology

Class 9

Overview: What is morphology?

- The study of the grammatical structure of *words*
 1. Processes of ***word-making*** (derivation: *run+er*)
and ***word-marking*** (inflection: *run+s*)
 2. The **internal structure** of **words**
 - their constituent parts and what they mean
 - how those parts can and can't be combined
 - Across the languages of the world
 3. People's **mental rules**
for constructing and understanding **words**
 - “rules” as consistent patterns, not prescriptive rules

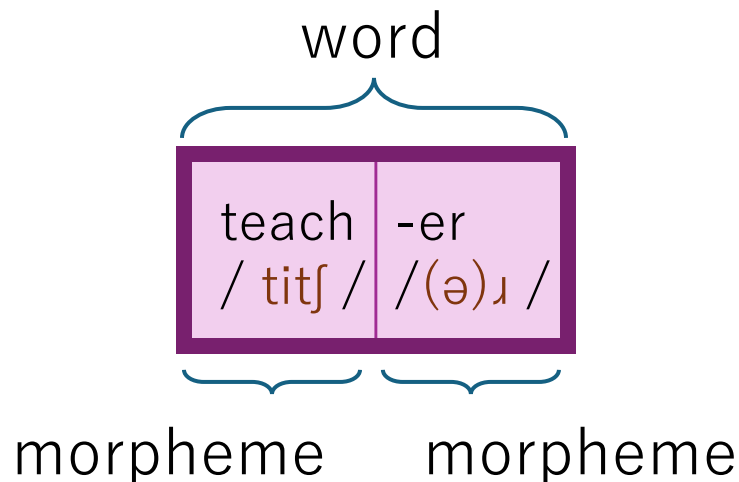
Overview: Important terminologies

• Word

- Smallest grammatically independent unit of language
- Assigned a particular part of speech (e.g., Noun, Verb)
- Made up of one or more **morphemes**

• Morpheme

- The smallest meaningful unit of language (irreducible)



Quiz 1: How many morphemes can you spot?

For each word below, decide how many morphemes it contains in Present-Day English.

unhappiness

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☒ 3 ☐ 4

cats

☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

uncharacteristically

☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5 ☐ 6

decentralization

☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5 ☐ 6

Quiz 1: How many morphemes can you spot?

For each word below, decide **how many morphemes** it contains in Present-Day English.

reindustrialization

☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5 ☐ 6

indecisiveness

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☒ 4

counterrevolutionary

☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☒ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6

unfriendliness

☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6

The citizens **revolted** against the dictator.

Quiz 1: How many morphemes can you spot?

Latin

volvere (volvō, volvī, volūtum)

(i) vi. 'roll'

(ii) vt. 'cause to roll'

re-volvere (revolvō, revolvī, revolūtum)

(i) vi. 'roll back'

(ii) vt. 'cause to roll back, revolve, unroll'

(1) *Pater* *libr-um* *re-vol-**v**-it.*

father.NOM book-ACC un-roll-**PRF**-3SG

'The father has read (unrolled) the book.'

(2) *Liber* *re-vol-**ūt**-us* *est* (*ā* *patre*).

book.NOM un-roll-**PTCP.PR****F**-M is (by father.ABL)

'The book has been read (unrolled) by the father.'

Quiz 1: How many morphemes can you spot?

Latin

volvere (volvō, volvī, volūtum)

- (i) vi. ‘roll’
- (ii) vt. ‘cause to roll’

re-volvere (revolvō, revolvī, revolūtum)

- (i) vi. ‘roll back’
- (ii) vt. ‘cause to roll back, revolve, unroll’

(3) *Crēdō* [*re-vol-ūt-iōn-em* *caelī*].

believe.1SG over-roll-PTCP.PRF-NMLZ-ACC.SG sky.GEN.SG

‘I believe in the revolution of the heavenly spheres.’

Etymologically the word ‘revolution’ can be split into 4 morphemes (in **Latin**).

However, in **English**, its compositionality is opaque; at least, “revolt” + “-tion” is what we are aware of.

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☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5 ☐ 6

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unfriendliness

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Quiz 1: How many morphemes can you spot?

For each word below, decide **how many morphemes** it contains in Present-Day English.

English

receive

☒ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

deceive

☒ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

conceive

☒ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

perceive

☒ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

Latin *capere* 'to seize'

recipere (re-+capere)

☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

decipere (de-+capere)

☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

concipere (con-+capere)

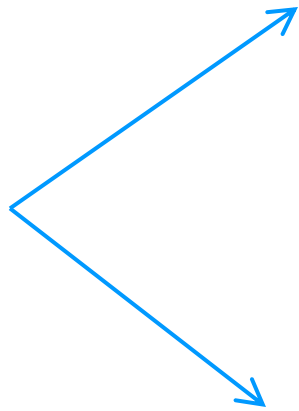
☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

percipere (per-+capere)

☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

capere 'to seize'

capere



receive
deceive
conceive
perceive

capture
captive
capacity
occupy
anticipate

Different types of morphemes

- **Free morpheme**

- A morpheme that can stand alone and be used as a word by itself

- **Lexical morphemes**

- *cat, dog, man, woman, perceive, ...*

- **Functional morphemes**

- *the, a, an, and, or, when, ...*

Different types of morphemes

- **Bound morpheme**

- A morpheme that must be attached to another morpheme

- **Derivational morphemes**

- Used to create **new words** and can change the lexical category of a word
- *pre-, un-, -ful, -ness, ...*

- **Inflectional morphemes**

- Used to **mark** a grammatical role in language
- Only 8 instances in English
- *-s (PL), -'s, -s (3sg), -ing, -ed, -en, -er (comp.), -est*

Quiz 2

Quiz 2 Terminologies

Which statement is correct?

- A. Every word consists of exactly one morpheme.
- B. Every free morpheme is a word, but not every morpheme is a word.
- C. Every bound morpheme is an inflectional morpheme.
- D. Every lexical morpheme is derivational.

B

- Free morphemes can stand alone as words (*book, run, happy*).
- Bound morphemes cannot (*un-*, *-ness*, *-s*).
- A is false because words such as **unhappiness** contain multiple morphemes.
- C is false because many bound morphemes are derivational (*un-*, *-ment*).
- D is false because lexical morphemes are content morphemes (*dog, sing, green*), not derivational affixes.

Quiz 3

Quiz 3: Terminologies

In the word *unfriendliness*, which classification is correct?

- A. *friend* is a functional morpheme.
- B. *un-* is a free derivational morpheme.
- C. *-ness* is a bound derivational morpheme.
- D. *-ly* is a bound inflectional morpheme.

C

- *friend*: free **lexical** morpheme
- *un-*: **bound** derivational morpheme
- *-ly*: bound derivational morpheme
- *-ness*: bound **derivational** morpheme

Quiz 4

Quiz 4: English tense markers

In English, the past tense marker **-ed** is typically analyzed as a **bound morpheme (suffix)**, as in (1)a.

- (1) a. Sarah **walk-ed** home. Past
- b. Sarah **will walk** home. Future

A student makes the following claim:

“*-ed* appears after the verb, so it is a **suffix** (*-ed*). *Will* appears before the verb. So, is it a **prefix** (*will-walk*), although orthographically we put a space in-between?”

- Do you agree with this proposal? Why or why not?

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- (1) a. Sarah **walk-ed** home. Past
- b. Sarah **will walk** home. Future

No.

Data 1 Question test

- a. ***-Ed** Sarah walk home yesterday?
- b. **Will** Sarah walk home tomorrow?

Quiz 4: English tense markers

In English, the past tense marker **-ed** is typically analyzed as a **bound morpheme (suffix)**, as in (1)a.

- (1) a. Sarah **walk-ed** home. Past
- b. Sarah **will walk** home. Future

No.

Data 2 Adverb test

- a.* Sarah walk **probably** -ed home yesterday.
- b. Sarah will **probably** walk home tomorrow.